SUBSCRIPTION ECONOMICS & PAYMENT RAILS

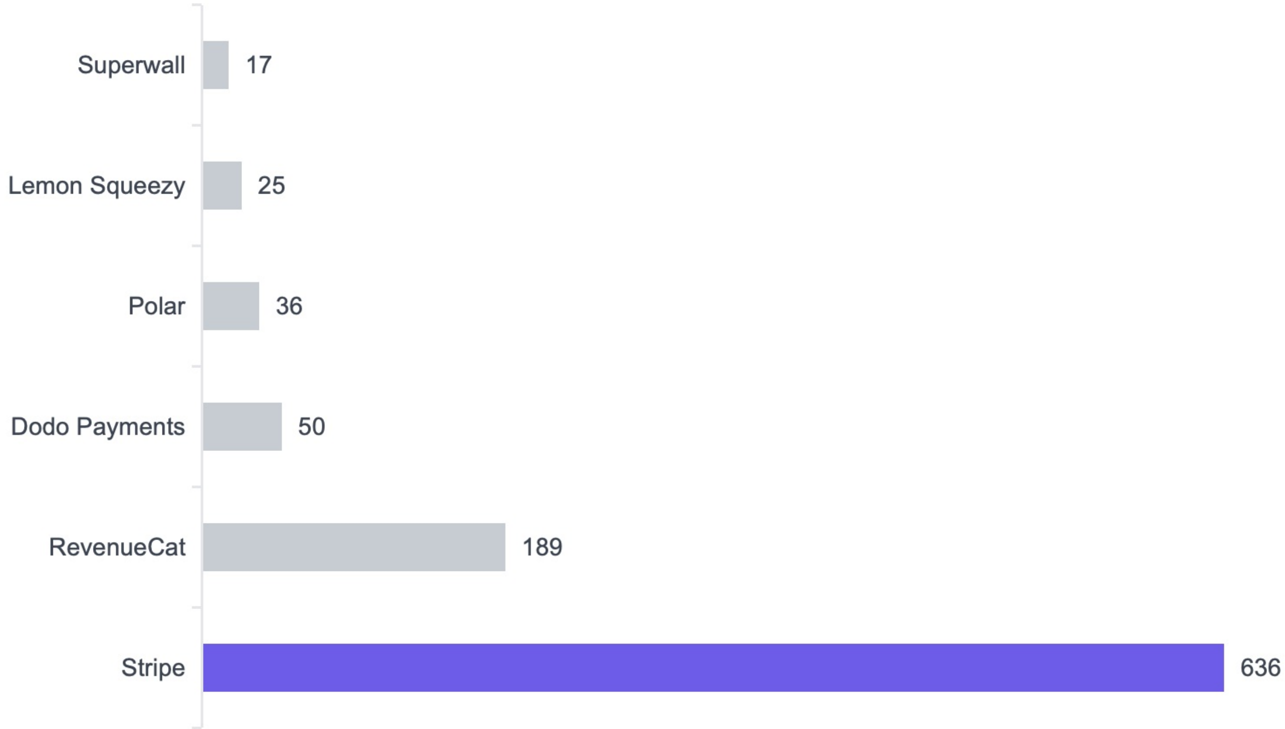
What Powers the Revenue?

A read on active subscriptions and payment infrastructure across 1,000 startups

Business Analysis · TrustMRR Dataset (n = 1,000) · Frozen 30 Jul 2026

THE RAILS

Stripe Is the Default — Nearly 2 in 3 Startups Run On It



63.6%

of all startups process payments through Stripe

$19.88

median revenue earned per active subscription

364

startups run on a non-Stripe or alternative rail

SUBSCRIBERS VS. REVENUE

More Subscriptions Track Tightly With More Revenue

READING THE PATTERN

- Subscriptions and revenue move together strongly (Spearman ≈ 0.82) — volume, not just price, is the main revenue driver.
- Median revenue per active subscription is just $19.88 — this is a low-ticket, high-volume market, not a premium one.
- The mean ($153/sub) sits far above the median, meaning a small set of high-ARPU startups skew the average upward.

SO WHAT

Implication: Infrastructure Choice Is Not a Differentiator

Stripe is table stakes

With ~64% share, 'accepts Stripe' carries no signal about quality or scale. Look at non-Stripe adoption as a possible niche or geography marker instead.

This is a volume game

A ~$20 median price point per subscription means growth has to come from acquisition volume, not price increases alone.

ARPU outliers need separate review

Startups with high revenue-per-subscription are a distinct segment (premium/B2B pricing) — analyze them apart from the volume-driven majority.